
PAPERBOY

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 2026

France's school revolt crossed into open confrontation, with 6,100 detained, more than 1,000 injured and nearly 2,000 schools blockaded on the students' union's own count.

AI

Mistral ships a trillion-parameter model trained on 3,800 GPUs, and holds the weights back three weeks

WHAT HAPPENED

Mistral released [Mistral Large 4](#) on Tuesday: a natively multimodal mixture-of-experts model with one trillion total parameters and 49 billion active, trained from scratch on 3,800 Nvidia Grace Blackwell GPUs in the company's own European data centres. The weights are not out. Access runs through a guarded endpoint, with an open-weight release promised by the end of October, and API pricing set at \$1.36 per million input tokens and \$4.18 per million output. VP Science Pierre Stock put the training compute at "two to three times less than our Chinese competitors, and significantly less than the closed source competitors". No benchmark results were published with the launch.

WHAT IT MEANS

Europe's only frontier lab is building a sovereignty argument out of efficiency: trained in Europe, on European metal, for a fraction of the compute its rivals use. Withholding weights while safety work finishes is new for Mistral, and it is the same open-weight-with-a-delay posture Reflection AI took on Monday.

WATCH NEXT

The weights, due by 31 October, and whether any benchmarks arrive with them.

Lambda in talks for \$4bn at a \$14.5bn pre-money valuation, with a \$50bn backlog behind it

WHAT HAPPENED

GPU cloud provider Lambda is raising up to \$4 billion at a \$14.5 billion pre-money valuation, led by Coatue Management and Blackstone, the Wall Street Journal reported Tuesday and [TechCrunch relayed](#). Lambda's contracted backlog went from \$15 billion in June to \$50 billion in September, a jump attributed largely to the \$35 billion commitment from Anthropic signed in late August. The listing Lambda had targeted for 2026 has slipped to 2027. Lambda, Coatue and Blackstone did not comment. The round is not closed and the underlying report is the Journal's alone.

WHAT IT MEANS

A contracted backlog is not revenue, and \$50 billion of it behind a \$14.5 billion pre-money valuation is the whole neocloud trade in one line: the contracts are enormous, and the equity is priced as though every counterparty pays. Anthropic alone is now most of that book.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the round closes at that number, and any 2027 filing.

Google buys 890 MW of new nuclear outright, in the first deal that pays for the reactors

WHAT HAPPENED

Google signed a 3,590 MW power agreement with Constellation Energy on Tuesday. Roughly 890 MW of it is new nuclear capacity from [uprates at 11 Constellation reactors](#) in Illinois, Pennsylvania and New Jersey, under a 20-year power purchase agreement, with a further 2,700 MW under a separate 15-year supply deal. Constellation will invest more than \$4.3 billion, with the first uprate expected by 2028, all inside the PJM grid serving 67 million people. Google energy chief Amanda Peterson Corio said the company is "committed to meeting our growth responsibly by actively investing in clean, reliable power that brings new capacity to our nation's grids". Constellation closed up 12.25% at \$300.40.

WHAT IT MEANS

Uprates are the only route to new nuclear megawatts this decade, and a hyperscaler is now paying for them directly rather than contracting for someone else's existing output. AI load has moved from reallocating generation to financing it, which is a materially different claim on the grid.

WATCH NEXT

Regulatory filings for the 11 uprates, and whether Microsoft or Amazon sign comparable uprate deals.

Nvidia closes at a record, 3.7% short of \$6 trillion

WHAT HAPPENED

Nvidia closed Tuesday at \$239.24, up 0.14%, a record, putting its market capitalisation at \$5.78 trillion and about 3.7% short of \$6 trillion. Monday did the heavy lifting, a 2.12% gain to \$238.90 with a \$240.10 intraday high. Behind the run: the \$150 billion buyback authorised on 28 September, contract manufacturer Foxconn's third-quarter revenue up 47% year-on-year, and easing rate anxiety after a weak payrolls print. Morgan Stanley's Joseph Moore kept Nvidia as his top semiconductor pick with a \$300 price target, calling the [valuation "reasonable"](#).

WHAT IT MEANS

The move is mechanical now rather than narrative. Nvidia, Apple and Microsoft are together over 21% of the S&P 500, so an index record and an Nvidia record are close to the same event. That is concentration risk wearing the costume of breadth.

WATCH NEXT

Whether \$6 trillion falls before Samsung's print on Thursday.

Samsung said to be seeking more than double current HBM pricing for 2027

WHAT HAPPENED

Samsung is in the final stage of 2027 HBM4 supply talks with Nvidia and Broadcom and is seeking prices more than double current HBM levels, Chosun Biz reported Tuesday. Next year's volume is said to be largely locked in with major customers, leaving price as the open item, and [Micron's reported success](#) pricing its own 2027 HBM higher is cited as strengthening Samsung's hand. KB Securities expects HBM selling prices up more than 100% next year; Hana Securities puts HBM at roughly 15% of Samsung's DRAM revenue in 2027. None of it is confirmed by Samsung, Nvidia or Broadcom, and the originating report is a single Korean outlet.

WHAT IT MEANS

If HBM4 clears at double, the memory squeeze stops being a 2026 margin story for three suppliers and becomes a 2027 cost line for everyone who buys an accelerator. That pass-through has to land somewhere, and still no phone or laptop maker has put a memory surcharge in writing.

WATCH NEXT

Any confirmation from the three parties, and Samsung's preliminary quarter Thursday.

Seoul sells the memory trade the morning after New York bought it

WHAT HAPPENED

The Kospi closed Wednesday at 6,803.90, down 137.49 points or 1.98%, with Samsung Electronics at 268,500 won, off 1.29%, and SK hynix at 1.72 million won, off 2.82%. The won sat at 1,340.4 to the dollar. Daishin Securities' Lee Kyung-min blamed [rising oil prices and US Treasury yields](#) plus caution before Samsung's results. Samsung's preliminary third quarter did not land early and is still due Thursday 8 October. TSMC has not filed September revenue either; its investor page still stops at August's NT\$514.8 billion, up 53.3% year-on-year.

WHAT IT MEANS

The same holdings that set records in New York on Tuesday night were sold in Seoul on Wednesday morning, which is what a crowded trade looks like when the catalyst is 24 hours out. The sell-side spread on Samsung's operating profit has widened rather than converged, so Thursday is a genuine event, not a formality.

WATCH NEXT

Samsung Thursday, then TSMC's September revenue around 10 October.

BUSINESS

Records for the S&P and Nasdaq, a fall for small caps, and a \$12.7bn widening in the trade deficit

WHAT HAPPENED

The S and P 500 closed Tuesday at 7,818.93, up 44.98 or 0.58%, and the Nasdaq Composite at 27,599.79, up 122.48 or 0.45%, both record closes. The Dow added 253.38 to 51,521.28, not a record, and the [Russell 2000 fell](#) 16.84 to 2,830.30. Treasury's own curve put the 2-year note at 4.79%, the 10-year at 5.27% and the 30-year at 5.64%, down five, four and two basis points. The August deficit in goods and services widened to [\\$105.6 billion](#) from a revised \$92.8 billion, imports up 4.3% and exports up 1.4%.

WHAT IT MEANS

Small caps fell on a record day for the megacap indices, and that divergence is the tell. A \$12.7 billion one-month widening driven by imports, not exports, reads as tariff front-running showing up in the hard data rather than the substitution the policy was meant to produce.

WATCH NEXT

September CPI on 14 October, PPI on 15 October, FOMC 27-28 October.

The 3-year goes at 4.932% with dealers taking barely a tenth, and \$61bn still to sell

WHAT HAPPENED

Treasury sold \$58 billion of 3-year notes on Tuesday at a 4.932% high yield with a 2.62 bid-to-cover and a 4.880% median. Of competitive accepted, direct bidders took 31.67%, indirect bidders 57.59% and primary dealers just 10.74%, which is the constructive read on demand. A \$39 billion 10-year reopening prices Wednesday afternoon and a \$22 billion 30-year reopening Thursday, both sizes [confirmed off Treasury's auction data](#), making \$119 billion of coupon supply in three days at the highest yields since 2002.

WHAT IT MEANS

The long end could not rally on weak payrolls or a soft services print, so it is absorbing supply without the help a slowdown usually provides. A dealer take-down near a tenth says real money is still turning up at these levels, and that is the only thing holding the curve together.

WATCH NEXT

Wednesday's 10-year tail, and whether the 10-year holds 5.25% into CPI.

Paramount closes Warner Bros. Discovery and becomes Skydance Corporation, with no stated deal value anywhere

WHAT HAPPENED

Paramount completed its acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery on Tuesday. The surviving registrant is Skydance Corporation, renamed from Paramount Skydance Corporation that day, trading Class B shares on the NYSE as SKYD under chairman and chief executive David Ellison, with WBD surviving as a wholly owned subsidiary. The [8-K](#) gives WBD holders \$31.01666668 a share in cash, about \$47 billion of new equity at \$12.00 a share, roughly \$41.9 billion of senior secured notes and about \$9.35 billion of credit facilities. No filing or company release states an aggregate transaction value, despite the \$110 billion and \$111 billion figures in circulation. Skydance claims nearly \$70 billion of combined annual revenue.

WHAT IT MEANS

CBS, CNN, HBO Max, Paramount+, MTV, DC and Westeros now answer to one family, financed with some \$51 billion of new debt at current rates. The regulatory price was settlements with a coalition of US states and a Hollywood writers' union, and Netflix walked away with its break fee covered.

WATCH NEXT

First consolidated guidance, and any conditions buried in the state settlements.

Anthropic gives startups a free year of Claude Team and \$1,000 in credits

WHAT HAPPENED

At SF Tech Week on Tuesday, Anthropic [widened its Claude for Startups programme](#): a free year of Claude Team with up to five premium seats, \$1,000 in API credits, access to Claude Marketplace for plug-in building, and virtual office hours with its Applied AI team. Eligibility covers companies founded within the last five years or funded within the last two. Anthropic's framing was that "the benefits of AI will reach most people through the companies that build on top of models, rather than through the models alone". No partner accelerators or funds were named.

WHAT IT MEANS

Subsidised seats are the cheapest distribution there is, and the lock-in is the codebase a startup writes against one API rather than the seats themselves. OpenAI and Google run the same play; the size of the giveaway is now the competitive variable.

WATCH NEXT

Whether OpenAI matches the free-year term.

Vinci raises \$250m at \$1.5bn to put physics reasoning into hardware design

WHAT HAPPENED

Vinci, which builds an AI-native computational platform for hardware engineering, closed a [\\$250 million Series B](#) at a \$1.5 billion valuation, co-led by Advent, Temasek and Xora, with AMD Ventures, Eclipse, Khosla Ventures and Madrona also in. The product offers what the company calls physics reasoning, letting engineers model thermal, thermo-mechanical and convective fluid behaviour during design rather than after it. No chief executive was named and no quotes were given in the only write-up available; the round is single-outlet and unconfirmed.

WHAT IT MEANS

AMD Ventures on the cap table points straight at the use case. Thermal design is now the binding constraint on accelerator packaging and data-centre layout, which makes simulation software a chip-adjacent asset rather than an engineering tool.

WATCH NEXT

A named customer, and whether a second outlet confirms the valuation.

Type One Energy takes \$200m for stellarator fusion

WHAT HAPPENED

Stellarator developer Type One Energy raised a [\\$200 million Series B](#) led by Breakthrough Energy Ventures and Clutterbuck Capital, with Lowercarbon Capital, Siemens Energy Ventures and SiteGround Capital participating. The company combines advanced manufacturing, computational physics and high-field superconducting magnets, and says it will use the money to expand operations and development. Christofer Mowry is chief executive. Also reported Tuesday and not individually date-verified: Capitolis at \$220 million total, Multiply Labs \$75 million, Sensible Biotechnologies \$47 million, Pro Shop \$24 million, Avarra and Siena at \$17 million each.

WHAT IT MEANS

Siemens Energy Ventures is the name to notice. A turbine maker buying optionality on a stellarator is the industrial supply chain pricing fusion as a 2030s procurement question rather than a physics one, and the money is arriving while data-centre load growth is bidding up every firm megawatt.

WATCH NEXT

A site announcement, and whether the round is confirmed outside FinSMEs.

A Boston judge stays the \$998-a-day immigration fines, with \$84bn already assessed

WHAT HAPPENED

Judge George A. O'Toole Jr. blocked the administration's programme of civil fines on migrants who stayed after final removal orders, in *Maria L. v. Mullin*, No. 1:25-cv-13471 (D. Mass.), decided Monday 5 October. The court stayed the rule and penalties issued under it, finding the agencies likely violated the Administrative Procedure Act by issuing a [27 June 2025 interim final rule](#), 90 FR 27439, without notice and comment, and that ICE's notice forms carried no specific allegations. The fines run at \$998 a day, retroactive up to five years, a theoretical maximum near \$1.8 million. Reuters put the programme at more than 103,000 fines totalling about \$84 billion as of July 2026.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is preliminary relief, not a vacatur. The statutory authority under the 1996 immigration act survives and the agencies can redo the rule with comment. Scope is contested: plaintiffs' counsel describes relief for everyone fined since 27 June 2025, while the Reuters wire limits it to cases filed in the district.

WATCH NEXT

A class-certification ruling, and whether DHS re-proposes the rule.

Two days on, the diesel tax order has produced no determination and no guidance

WHAT HAPPENED

The 5 October executive order deferring diesel excise taxes has so far produced nothing. It gives the Treasury Secretary five days to determine whether the relief is authorised under existing tax law, and then requires guidance [identifying eligible taxpayers](#), covered liabilities, deadlines and repayment terms. As of Wednesday morning there is no determination, no IRS guidance and no Federal Register citation. The order's operative effect in the meantime is that tax-free red-dyed diesel may be burned on highways through year end, previously an offence. November WTI settled Tuesday at \$89.44 a barrel and December Brent at \$100.58.

WHAT IT MEANS

A deferral is a loan, not a cut, and until Treasury says the deferral is lawful nobody knows whether the money comes back. Vitol's Russell Hardy explained the pressure at the Energy Intelligence Forum: the West needs 10 to 14 million barrels out through the shipping route this winter, "because there aren't any more inventories to drain in the West".

WATCH NEXT

The Treasury determination, due around 10 October.

Nothing signed, Congress away, and the AI force still has no instrument

WHAT HAPPENED

Three primary-source checks came back empty, which is itself the shape of the week. The [presidential-actions list](#) carries nothing for 6 or 7 October; the most recent entries remain the diesel order of 5 October and a Manufacturing Day proclamation of 2 October. The House clerk shows the next session on 9 October at 12:30. And the Super Intelligence Force announced on 4 October, with Jay Clayton as chair, still has no charter, executive order or memorandum in the Federal Register or on the presidential-actions page, a third consecutive day.

WHAT IT MEANS

The body meant to run American AI policy exists as a social-media post and a list of names. Until an instrument exists, nothing it decides is reviewable, challengeable or binding, which cuts both ways: it also means nothing it decides can be stopped in court.

WATCH NEXT

A charter or executive order, and Clayton's 120-day report clock, which cannot start without one.

WORLD POLITICS

India hikes 25bp and switches to calibrated tightening, its first since 2018

WHAT HAPPENED

The Reserve Bank of India raised its policy repo rate 25 basis points to 5.50% on Wednesday, the first hike after an easing cycle that had held 5.25% since December 2025. The monetary policy committee was [unanimous on the rate](#) but split four to two on the stance, which moved from neutral to "calibrated tightening" for the first time since October 2018; Nagesh Kumar and Ram Singh wanted neutral kept. Inflation for 2026-27 was revised up to 5.2% from 5.0%, with the third quarter at 6.0%, and growth up to 7.1% from 6.7%. Governor Sanjay Malhotra said cuts are off the table in the near term.

WHAT IT MEANS

A central bank raising rates while revising growth upward is not fighting a slowdown. It is conceding that 7% growth is producing 6% inflation. India now tightens into strength alongside the Fed, which narrows considerably the list of large economies still easing.

WATCH NEXT

The 6.0% third-quarter print, and whether the two dissenters move.

Brazil's right consolidates behind Flavio Bolsonaro, and the PL settles at 121 seats

WHAT HAPPENED

Goiás governor Ronaldo Caiado, who finished fifth with 2.60 million votes and 2.18% of valid votes, [endorsed Flavio Bolsonaro](#) in Goiania on Tuesday, pledging the state's machinery and telling him "243 prefeituras vao estar com voce". Romeu Zema and Michel Temer had already endorsed; Sao Paulo's Tarcisio de Freitas attended. Caiado ran for PSD, which has freed its state directories rather than endorsing as a party. The Chamber count has settled at 121 seats for the PL, the largest bench since redemocratisation, per the Chamber itself at 99.99% of machines counted, against 99 in 2022.

WHAT IT MEANS

Flavio's first-round margin over Lula was 2.22 million votes, less than Caiado and fourth-placed Renan Santos took between them. The right is assembling exactly the arithmetic it needs, and the Chamber it would govern with is already the most right-wing on record.

WATCH NEXT

Datafolha's first runoff poll Thursday, AtlasIntel's Friday, the runoff 25 October.

France: 1,015 injured, 6,100 detained and 1,483 minors facing prosecution over school conditions

WHAT HAPPENED

French school protests turned into open confrontation with riot police on Tuesday. Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu told the National Assembly that 215 students, 715 police and gendarmes and 85 education staff have been injured since the movement began a fortnight ago; the Interior Ministry counts 6,100 detentions and the Justice Ministry 1,802 prosecutions, 1,483 of them minors. On Tuesday alone 488 people were detained and 43 officers hurt. The High School Students Union says nearly 2,000 schools were [blockaded or closed](#), its own count and a sharp jump from the 400 to 500 reported on 5 October. Authorities put turnout at 250,000, organisers at 500,000.

WHAT IT MEANS

A strike is a negotiation. Prosecuting 1,483 children over absent teachers, broken buildings and overcrowded classrooms is something else, and it is the part that will outlast the blockades. Lecornu has opened five workstreams and asked ministers for proposals before the end of October, which is an admission the demands are not unreasonable.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the blockades hold past the holidays, and Lecornu's proposals.

SOURCES

Mistral AI - Mistral Large 4

TechCrunch - Mistral's new 1T model

TechCrunch - Lambda to raise \$4bn ahead of planned IPO

TechCrunch - Anthropic gives startups a free year

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Seoul Economic Daily - Nvidia nears \$6 trillion

Stock Analysis - NVDA

SammyFans - Samsung HBM4 price talks enter final stage (relaying Chosun Biz)

Korea JoongAng Daily - Kospi drops nearly 2 percent

TSMC - monthly revenue 2026

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US Treasury - daily par yield curve, October 2026

BEA - US international trade in goods and services, August 2026

US Treasury fiscal data - auction results, 6 October 2026

SEC - Skydance Corporation Form 8-K, 6 October 2026

TechCrunch - Paramount closes Warner Bros. merger

FinSMEs - Vinci raises \$250m Series B

FinSMEs - Type One Energy raises \$200m Series B

Federal Register - Imposition and Collection of Civil Penalties, 90 FR 27439

Public Justice - federal court blocks immigration fines

Akin Gump - Emergency Tax Relief on Diesel Fuel tracker

Rigzone - oil steady as Middle East exports rise

The White House - presidential actions

Reserve Bank of India - MPC resolution, 5 to 7 October 2026

Poder360 - Caiado endorses Flavio Bolsonaro

CNN Brasil - Chamber benches by party

Al Jazeera - demonstrators clash with riot police in France

LCP - mobilisation lyceenne, Lecornu at the National Assembly